

Hook:

- If you saw the words Black widow on a news headline, what would you think the news would be about?
- News is supposed to show us all sides of the coin. But what if they show every side but the perpetrator?

Notes:

- They never really interview these 'women' that are accused of marrying the army recruits for money nor do they ask the reasoning behind the action
 - Show how the media makes fun of these things and assume things of the women
 - Eg
 - The podcast
- The bad economy in Russia
- Sure they want money, but what for?
- The article focuses heavily on the accusation that women are marrying soldiers for financial compensation, which can create a negative impression on them
 - Why are we only talking about the women here?
 - E.g., the news mentioned someone's dad (59), marrying a woman (22 years younger) a day before he was sent to fight. Is the 20 year age gap not concerning?
 - Mind you that the average age gap in typical Russian couples is 3-5 years.
 - With how popular this is, shouldn't the military recruits be smarter/more aware of these scams?

Bias

- What is bias? When a news source presents information in a way that favors a particular perspective, interpretation, or viewpoint
 - Why do they do this? For views. Whether it's through appealing to a certain audience or ragebait (making people angry on purpose so they get attention)
- How does it happen?
 - Language
 - Journalists hold the power when choosing certain words that can create a positive or negative feeling
 - Ex: calling women "black widows" creates a negative impression than simply describing them as women who marry soldiers
 - Selection of information
 - Focusing heavily on dramatic cases can make an issue seem more common or extreme
 - They choose who to interview, where they get their info, statistics and others that get included in the news
 - Framing
 - The same event can be presented from different perspectives
 - Perspective A = the original
 - Perspective B = the reasoning on why women choose to enter these marriages.
- How it affects the audience?
 - What we think
 - How we feel
 - What we remember

- What we believe in important
- How we judge people
- Final takeaway:
 - We always wanna know what people are thinking of, what is their reasoning for doing certain things? Sometimes we don't always get the right perspectives to understand that. So its our job as audiences to ask ourselves: whose perspective am i reading from and whose perspective might be missing?

If you saw the words Black widow on a news headline, what would you think the news would be about? You'd probably think it was something negative, but do we ever think about what the people called it feel?

Today ill be talking about the news: 'Black widows': Women accused of marrying Russian army recruits to claim death payouts. I got this news from cnn and was published on 6 august 2026.

I believe this article is slightly biased due to how it is framed, their wording and who they interview. In both the article they never interview the 'women' or the 'black widows' that are accused of marrying the army recruits for money nor do they ask the reasoning for these actions (yes the reasoning is for money, but what will the money be used for?).

Not to mention the media makes fun of these, one example is in a podcast where they mock the idea by saying "if im a woman and i want to buy an apartment, where am i supposed to get money?" "it's simple, just find a man whos serving in the military and wait for him to die so you get the death pay out" Not only is this insensitive to the victims but its also underestimates the reasoning behind the reason they do this. Some could be doing this for financial security due to the bad economy in russia or maybe they want a better life for themselves.

The article focuses heavily on the women, but what about the men who choose to accept the marriages? One interview from the article shows a woman crying, she explains her shock when she found out the inheritance that was meant for her from her fathers death, went to a woman that he married just day before being sent to fight. Mind you, her dad is 59, the woman is 22.

37 year age gap. **37** is that not concerning at all? Not to mention that the average age gap in typical russian couples is 3-5 years. And with how popular this is, shouldnt these military recruits be more aware of this problem?

And thats the problem.

Journalists, hold the power when it comes to choosing what should or should not be put in the article. They control the language, the selection of information and its framing. Because of this We always wanna know what people are thinking of, what is their reasoning for doing certain things? Sometimes we don't always get the right perspectives to understand that. So its our job as audiences to ask ourselves: whose perspective am i reading from and whose perspective might be missing?

Fixed version:

If you saw the words Black widow on a news headline, what would you think the news would be about? You'd probably think it was either of these 3 things: something negative (relating to death), the marvel hero or the spider. For now it will be about the label being given. Now, do we ever think about what the people called it feel?

Today I'll be discussing about media bias, and how it can affect our perspectives on certain matters. The example I'll be using for this presentation is : 'Black widows': Women accused of marrying Russian army recruits to claim death payouts. I got this news from cnn and was published on 6 august 2026.

I believe this article is slightly biased due to how it is framed, their wording and who they interview. In both the article and the video in the article, they never interview the 'women' or the 'black widows' that are accused of marrying the army recruits for money nor do they ask the reasoning for these actions (yes the reasoning is for money, but what will the money be used for?).

Not to mention the media makes fun of these, one example is in a podcast where they mock the idea by saying "if im a woman and i want to buy an apartment, where am i supposed to get money?" "it's simple, just find a man whos serving in the military and wait for him to die so you get the death pay out" Not only is this insensitive toward the women accused of these marriages, but it also overlooks the circumstances that may have led them to make these choices . Some could be doing this for financial security due to the bad economy in russia or maybe they want a better life for themselves.

The article focuses heavily on the women's action, but what about the men who choose to accept the marriages? One interview from the article shows a woman crying, as she explains her shock when she found out the inheritance that was meant for her from her fathers death, went to a woman that he married just day before being sent to fight. Mind you, her dad is 59, the woman is 22 years his junior or 22 years younger than him .

22 year age gap. **22** is that not concerning at all? Not to mention that the average age gap in typical russian couples is 3-5 years. And with how popular this is, shouldnt these military recruits be more aware of this problem?

And thats the problem.

Journalists, hold the power when it comes to choosing what should or should not be put in the article. They control the language, the selection of information and its framing. Because of this We always wanna know what people are thinking of, what is their reasoning for doing certain things? Sometimes we don't always get the right perspectives to understand that. So its our job as audiences to ask ourselves: whose perspective am i reading from and whose perspective might be missing?